

Uploading Book PDFs to IngramSpark

via a Linux desktop (VNC) inside Google Cloud Shell

Full self-contained walkthrough for uploading the print files to IngramSpark from a phone whose normal file picker doesn't work. You run a real Linux desktop with Firefox inside Google Cloud Shell (free), streamed to your phone. The book files are pulled straight into that desktop from GitHub, so the phone is just a screen.

■ Cloud Shell wipes installed packages and the desktop between sessions, but files in your home folder (~) survive. If you come back later, re-run Part A steps 1–3; your saved token (Part B) still works.

Part A — Start the Linux desktop + Firefox

1. On your phone open <https://shell.cloud.google.com>, sign in, wait for the black terminal.
2. Install the desktop and a real Firefox (paste as one block):

```
sudo apt-get update -y && sudo apt-get install -y fluxbox tigervnc-standalone-server novnc websockify
cd ~ && rm -rf firefox firefox.tar.xz
wget --content-disposition -O firefox.tar.xz "https://download.mozilla.org/?product=firefox-latest&os=linux64&"
tar xf firefox.tar.xz
ls ~/firefox/firefox && echo "FIREFOX OK"
```

If Firefox won't launch later (missing libraries):

```
sudo apt-get install -y libgtk-3-0 libdbus-glib-1-2 libx11-xcb1
```

3. Start the GUI. The **exec fluxbox** line is critical — without it the VNC session exits instantly:

```
mkdir -p ~/.vnc
printf '#!/bin/sh\nxsetroot -solid grey 2>/dev/null\n%s/firefox/firefox &\nexec fluxbox\n' "$HOME" > ~/.vnc/xstartup
chmod +x ~/.vnc/xstartup
tigervncserver -kill :1 2>/dev/null
tigervncserver :1 -geometry 1280x800 -localhost no -SecurityTypes None --I-KNOW-THIS-IS-INSECURE
pkill websockify 2>/dev/null; sleep 1
websockify --web=/usr/share/novnc 8080 localhost:5901 >/tmp/novnc.log 2>&1 &
echo "started"
```

Portrait phone screen? swap **-geometry 1280x800** for **-geometry 800x1280**.

4. Open the desktop: Cloud Shell toolbar (top-right) → **Web Preview** (monitor/eye icon, maybe under ■) → **Change port** → **8080** → **Change and Preview**. If you see a directory listing or 404, add **/vnc.html** to the URL. Tap **Connect** — grey desktop with Firefox.
5. Hard to navigate? noVNC tab on the **left edge** → gear → **Scaling Mode** → **Local Scaling** (fits the whole desktop). Fullscreen button is there too.

Part B — Get the book files into Cloud Shell

1. Make a GitHub token (classic)

Phone's normal browser, logged into GitHub: **Settings** → **Developer settings** → **Personal access tokens** → **Tokens (classic)** → **Generate new token (classic)** → tick the top-level **repo** box → Generate → copy it (ghp_...).

■ A valid classic token is ghp_ + 36 chars = **40 characters total**. A different length means the paste grabbed extra/missing characters — the usual cause of **HTTP 401 Bad credentials**. Never paste a token into a

chat/log; revoke any that lands in one.

2. (Recommended) Save the token so you never re-paste it

Files in ~ survive between sessions. Save it once (never into a repo — GitHub auto-revokes committed tokens):

```
echo 'export GH_TOKEN=PASTE_YOUR_TOKEN_HERE' > ~/.github_token
chmod 600 ~/.github_token
```

Every future session, instead of pasting the token, run:

```
source ~/.github_token
TOKEN=$GH_TOKEN
```

3. Sanity-check the token before downloading

```
curl -sL -o /dev/null -w "HTTP %{http_code}\n" -H "Authorization: token $TOKEN" \
  "https://api.github.com/repos/knightdx91-alt/The-Saeren-Chronicles"
```

200 = good. **401** = bad/mistyped token (re-check length). **404** = no access (use a classic token with the repo scope).

4. Download the files (Book One, barcode-fixed, press-ready)

```
rm -f ~/Downloads/*
cd ~/Downloads
source ~/.github_token; TOKEN=$GH_TOKEN      # or: TOKEN=PASTE_YOUR_TOKEN_HERE
api="https://api.github.com/repos/knightdx91-alt/The-Saeren-Chronicles/contents"
get(){ curl -sL -H "Authorization: token $TOKEN" -H "Accept: application/vnd.github.raw" -o "$2" "$api/$1"; }

get "book/genesis/saeren-chronicles/delivery/cover/Saeren-Book-One-FULL-WRAP-r3-PDFX1a.pdf" cover.pdf
get "book/genesis/saeren-chronicles/delivery/production/Saeren-Chronicles-Book-One-6x9-interior-r14-PDFX1a.pdf" interior.pdf

echo "=== want real sizes + %PDF header, NOT ~112 bytes ==="
for f in cover.pdf interior.pdf; do printf "%-12s " "$f"; ls -lh "$f"|awk '{print $5}'|tr -d '\n'; printf " hd"
```

■ **USE THE -PDFX1a COVER.** The plain -CMYK-noicc file previews **blank/white** on IngramSpark and phone viewers because it has no OutputIntent. PDF/X-1a (CMYK + OutputIntent) is what IngramSpark expects and previews correctly — same format as the interior.

■ **THE 112-BYTE FILE:** if a file is ~112 bytes or its header prints {, the token is wrong and you downloaded a GitHub error. Run **cat ~/Downloads/cover.pdf** to read it, fix the token, re-run. A real cover shows **%PDF** and ≈ 3.9 MB.

Other books: change the two paths. Book Two → book/genesis/saeren-chronicles-book-2/, Book Three → book/genesis/saeren-chronicles-book-3/. Always use the **-PDFX1a** files.

Part C — Upload settings on IngramSpark

In the Cloud Shell Firefox go to **ingramspark.com**, log in, open your title, start the upload. When the picker opens, choose files from **Home** → **Downloads**.

Cover: choose “**my cover already includes a barcode**” (a.k.a. “I supply my own barcode”) so IngramSpark does NOT overlay its own white barcode box on ours.

Interior: the 6×9 PDF/X-1a (294 pages, Book One).

ICC-profile warning if shown is **non-blocking** — proceed.

Cover size: 12.91 × 9.25 in, full-bleed, spine 0.661" (294pp cream), no white margins.

eBook is a separate format: its interior must be an **EPUB** (a PDF is rejected there).

■ If a preview ever shows blank, confirm you uploaded the **-PDFX1a** file, not -CMYK-noicc. Before approving for sale, order a printed proof and confirm the barcode scans.

Quick reference — Book One files

cover : delivery/cover/Saeren-Book-One-FULL-WRAP-r3-PDFX1a.pdf (CMYK + OutputIntent)
interior : delivery/production/Saeren-Chronicles-Book-One-6x9-interior-r14-PDFX1a.pdf

Barcode verified: EAN-13 = 9798240990434 (ISBN 979-8-2409-9043-4), single barcode, no price add-on.

When done: revoke any exposed GitHub token and overwrite ~/.github_token with a fresh one.